

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 217

By Walley

A RESOLUTION to recognize and commend the ALStar Youth Leadership Conference on its fifth anniversary.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in recognizing those estimable events that are devoted to improving the lives of young people in this State; and

WHEREAS, one such event is the ALStar Youth Leadership Conference, the first conference of its kind, which fosters African-American youth leadership in West Tennessee, bringing together students from public schools in seventeen counties throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, in 2020, at the height of the COVID-19 pandemic, Alex Beene of Chester County, Terrence Lurry of Fayette County, Chris Kee of Fayette County, Brandon Jones of Hardeman County, Sam Williams of Fayette County, and Emmanuel Casem of Fayette County came up with the concept for the ALStar Youth Leadership Conference, with guidance provided by Damio Yancy and Craig Clay; and

WHEREAS, the conference was also the result of a partnership between these men, the University of Tennessee at Martin (UTM), and the WestStar Leadership team; UTM has facilitated the conference for the last five years in multiple counties and virtually and has handled the design of the event, recruitment, and the agenda students participate in throughout the day; and

WHEREAS, held in January of each year, the ALStar Youth Leadership Conference guides young people in the areas of professional development, financial literacy, leadership techniques, and team building, encouraging them to take leadership roles in their respective counties; and

WHEREAS, since its inception, the ALStar Youth Leadership Conference has served hundreds of students, many of whom have gone on to become leaders at their schools and in

their communities and to attend over twenty-five different colleges and universities throughout the state, earning over \$1 million in scholarships; and

WHEREAS, thanks to the efforts of a group of intrepid young founders, the University of Tennessee at Martin, the WestStar Leadership team, and the public schools in the area, more African-American high school students will become leaders to guide the next generation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we recognize and commend the ALStar Youth Leadership Conference for its service to the youth of West Tennessee, extending our deepest gratitude for the conference's important work and our best wishes for its continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.